



College of Sciences
Department of Computer Science

Course Syllabus

Course Title
Professional, Social, & Ethical Issues in Computer Science

Course Code

1501322

Section 01

Fall Semester, 2025/2026

Course Syllabus

Course Title	Professional, Social, & Ethical Issues in Computer Science		
Course Code	1501322		
Credit Hours	2		
Pre-requisite(s)	None		
Co-requisite(s)	None		
Semester	Fall	Year	2025/2026
Instructors Name	Dr Fanar ShwedeH		
Office Location	W5-232		
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Lecture Times	Wed 14:00 – 15:30		
Office Hours	Mon 12:00 - 14:00		

Course Description (as in the catalogue):

This course introduces students to several social, ethical, and professional issues related to Information Technologies and its applications. The covered topics include the philosophical grounds for different ethical theories in conjunction with its implications on several aspects, including but not limited to the balance between privacy and security for individual and civil liberties at large, copyrights and intellectual properties, email and spam, the morality of breaking the law, Internet addiction, data mining, identity theft, computer reliability, professional ethics, among others. Several case studies are introduced for each topic to assist students in contextualizing and formulating their own ethical stances and values that will motivate their actions in the future.

Course Objectives/Goals:

The goals of this course are to:

- Introduce the ethical principles in computing, different ethical issues, and responsibility in using the new technologies.
- Discuss legislation of censorship laws for the Internet.
- Discuss responsibility towards protecting intellectual property and dealing with computer crimes.
- Discuss ethical issues for computer professionals.

Course Learning Outcomes:

By the end of successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

1. Identify major features and principles of ethical theories used in the IT domain.
2. Apply different ethical issues in using information technology.
3. Analyze and compare workable ethical theories and problems related to the use of new technology.
4. Judge the right use of different cyberspace technologies.
5. Select and discuss proper ethical theories in using technology for real-life applications.

Alignment of Course Student Learning Outcomes to the BSIT Program Student Learning Outcomes

IT Multimedia Program SLOs		Course SLOs
Analyze a complex computing problem and to apply principles of computing and other relevant disciplines to identify solutions.	Analyze	3
	Apply	2
Design, implement, and evaluate a computing-based solution to meet a given set of computing requirements in the context of the program's discipline.	Design	-
	Implement	5
	Evaluate	4
Communicate effectively in a variety of professional contexts.		-
Describe professional responsibilities and make informed judgments in computing practice based on legal and ethical principles.		1
Function effectively as a member or leader of a team engaged in activities appropriate to the program's discipline.		-
Identify and analyze user needs and to take them into account in the selection, creation, integration, evaluation, and administration of computing-based systems.	Identify / Analyze	1, 3
	Development	5

Alignment of Course Student Learning Outcomes to the BSCS Program Student Learning Outcomes

Computer Science Program SLOs		Course SLOs
Analyze a complex computing problem and to apply principles of computing and other relevant disciplines to identify solutions.	Analyze	3
	Apply	2
Design, implement, and evaluate a computing-based solution to meet a given set of computing requirements in the context of the program's discipline.	Design	-
	Implement	5
	Evaluate	4
Communicate effectively in a variety of professional contexts.		-

Computer Science Program SLOs		Course SLOs
Describe professional responsibilities and make informed judgments in computing practice based on legal and ethical principles.		3
Function effectively as a member or leader of a team engaged in activities appropriate to the program's discipline.		-
Apply computer science theory and software development fundamentals to produce computing-based solutions.	Theory	1, 3
	Development	-

Weekly Distribution of Course Topics/Contents

Week	Topic	Term Project
1 27 Aug	Introduction to Course + Introduction to Ethics in the Cyber World I	
2 3 Sep	Introduction to Ethics in the Cyber World II	
3 10 Sep	Ethical Theories - I	Term Project Group Forming
4 17 th Sep	Ethical Theories - II	Term Project Selection
5 24 Sep	Ethical Theories - III	
6 1 Oct	Networked World - I	
7 8 th Oct	Networked World - II	
8 15 th Oct	Protecting Software & Other Intellectual Property (IP) - I	Term Project 1 st Report
15 – 22 Oct	Mid-Term Exam	
9 22 th Oct	Protecting Software & Other Intellectual Property (IP) - II	
10 29 th Oct	Information Privacy - I	
11 5 Nov	Information Privacy - II	
12 12 th Nov	Professional Ethics - I	
13 19 th Nov	Professional Ethics – II	Term Project Report
14 26 th Nov	Presentations by the Students	Term Project Presentations
15 3 rd Dec	Presentations by the Students	
	Revision and Final Exam	

Students' Assessment:

Students are assessed as follows:

Assessment Tool(s)**	Weight (%)
Midterm Exam	25
Coursework (Term Project)	30
Final Exam	45
Total	100

Course Outcome Assessment Plan:

Course LOs	Teaching/Learning Method(s)	Assessment Tool(s)	Performance Indicators
Identify major features and principles of ethical theories used in IT.	Interactive Lectures and multimedia Case Studies	Written Exams and term project	Percentage of graded Project and Exams.
Apply different ethical issues in using information technology.	Interactive Lectures, Multimedia Case Studies + Practical Tutorials	Written Exams and term project	Percentage of graded Project and Exams.
Analyze and compare workable ethical theories and problems related to the use of new technology.	Interactive Lectures and multimedia Case Studies	Written Exams and term project	Percentage of graded Project and Exams.
Judge the right use of cyberspace technology.	Interactive Lectures and multimedia Case Studies	Written Exams and term project	Percentage of graded Project and Exams.
Select and discuss proper ethical theories in using technology in the real life.	Interactive Lectures and multimedia Case Studies	Written Exams and term project	Percentage of graded Project and Exams.
Establish, Justify and Communicate ethical and professional stances.	Interactive Lectures and multimedia Case Studies	Written Exams and term project	Percentage of graded Project and Exams.

Teaching and Learning Resources:**Textbook(s):**

Michael Quinn, 2018. *Ethics for the Information Age*, 8th Ed. (8th edition available online) Pearson.

Sara Baase, 2012. *A Gift of Fire: Social Legal and Ethical Issues in Computing*, 4ed. Prentice Hall",

Additional References:

Richard A. Spinello. (2011). *"Cyberethics: Morality and Law in Cyberspace"*, Johns & Bartlett Learning.

Other Resources:

Internet and the Library (digital and/or physical)

Throughout the semester, several individual and team assignments that cover the different major topics of the course will be required. In a course project (term paper), students are asked to explore topics related to information technology with respect to ethics. Students are asked to present and discuss their project in class.

Attendance policy:

Attendance is compulsory. A student missing 10% (6 hours) of the total allocated course hours will receive 1st warning notice and a student missing 15% (9 hours) will receive 2nd warning notice. A student missing 20% (12 hours or more) will be forced to withdraw (in accordance with the university regulations).

Plagiarism/Cheating:

Students are expected to do their own work individually unless otherwise instructed to work in groups. Students are encouraged to communicate and exchange expertise on different course topics but submitted work should be unique and genuine efforts of student/group own work. The instructor is available to provide any assistance that you may need. Cheating is considered a serious offense by the university. You should be aware of the severe penalty for cheating (refer to the student code of conduct published in the university catalogue).

Notes:**Teaching Methodology:**

A hybrid of traditional lectures for 20-30 minutes followed by discussions/questions and answers where you (students) are encouraged to answer/debate/discuss each other questions and answers. This enforces your ownership of the material taught in class. To achieve this objective, we will use:

In-class presentations:

Students are assigned or they select topics to present in the class. Findings may take the form of either prepared for in-class presentation or just open discussion. In-class brainstorming: Students are divided into small teams to examine and discuss a topic or provide feedback on some open problems/topics.

Term Paper:

Students in teams on a related topic to address, expose, analyze, or justify an ethical stance in context. The outcome group paper is expected to be 3000 – 4500 words to be submitted after revisions as needed.

Academic Integrity:

Any attempts to cheat will lead to appropriate action (the University rules will be strictly followed). Work assigned is expected to be done individually unless otherwise stated